Text-Driven Humanoid Grasping: Motion Generators and Structured Predictive Residual Control

DASC7606C Group 3

***Abstract*— We develop a text-driven tabletop grasping system for the Unitree G1, connecting two pretrained motion generators, ARDY and Kimodo, to a common SONIC whole-body controller. On the shared 100-scene benchmark, both generators initially meet the grasp threshold in 58 trials, but Kimodo retains 55 grasps and ARDY 40; ARDY responds faster. We introduce a learned predictive interface between nominal motion and corrective control. A temporal Transformer organizes measured history and upcoming nominal motion into body-by-time risk tokens; a second consumes these predicted tokens to generate bounded arm corrections. In an independent paired evaluation of the ARDY-based system, the learned controller raises end-to-end success from 54/124 (43.55%) to 74/124 (59.68%): a 16.13 percentage-point gain, with 25 rescues and five harms. The exact paired result, $p = 0.000325$, passes the prespecified threshold of 0.00625. A separate invocation study retains full structured Risk conditioning in both learned modes, obtaining 10/20 successes with selective correction and 14/20 with always-on correction. These configurations share the predictive interface while varying when Residual runs. Annotated videos link instructions, execution stages, and both successful and failed object interactions.**

I. Introduction

Natural-language humanoid manipulation combines motion generation with physical execution. A generator can describe how a robot should reach, lower its hand, and lift an object; successful grasping additionally requires accurate finger–object alignment, stable contact, sufficient clearance, and retention throughout the motion. A visually plausible reach can therefore track well and still fail to pick up a block.

We implement this complete route in simulation using ARDY [1] and Kimodo [2] as two distinct text-to-motion baselines, both executed through pretrained SONIC [3]. A common G1 reference interface, tabletop scene, staged language coordinator, and separate finger controller support the comparison. ARDY provides interactive autoregressive generation conditioned on measured motion history; Kimodo provides controllable kinematic motion diffusion with native spatial constraints. Their different conditioning interfaces expose a practical question: which generated motions remain useful after whole-body tracking and physical hand–object interaction?

Our team visited Archon and learned about S0/S1 models and the simulation-to-robot gap. This experience motivated an execution-side extension that preserves the pretrained motion pipeline. Its central component is a learned predictive interface: Risk combines recent execution and upcoming nominal motion into tokens indexed by future time and body region, and Residual consumes these predicted tokens to request bounded arm corrections. Auxiliary execution prediction trains the representation; correction supervision connects it to physical behavior. A separate scalar head schedules Residual invocation, allowing the same conditioning pathway to operate continuously or selectively.

The design asks whether predicted execution risk can inform both when and how to correct a nominal motion. Our contributions are a shared ARDY/Kimodo-to-SONIC grasping system, a structured predictive interface coupling future-execution prediction to residual correction, and task-level evaluation of both. The baseline comparison uses 100 trials per generator. A separate independent paired confirmation demonstrates a 16.13 percentage-point improvement over ARDY without retraining ARDY or SONIC. A same-weight study compares invocation schedules while preserving structured Risk conditioning. Videos show the text, motion, and object interaction behind these results.

II. Background and Archon Session

A. Archon Session

All team members attended the supervised Archon visit and learned about S0/S1 models, demonstration recording, and policy inference. Archon's whole-body intelligence perspective treats a humanoid as a coordinated embodied system: arm motion depends on posture, balance, contact, and the environment, so a plausible hand trajectory alone does not specify an executable manipulation [4].

Archon's published hierarchy separates semantic reasoning (S2), native multimodal humanoid modeling (S1), motion generation with a Behavior Foundation Model (S0.5), and motion execution (S0) [4]. This distinction helped us identify two interfaces in our project. ARDY and Kimodo supply movement intent, while SONIC turns adapted references into whole-body control. Our execution-side extension then feeds measured behavior back into the reference through predictive Risk and bounded Residual correction. Its body/time structure connects an upcoming manipulation problem to the region and interval where corrective control can act.

Demonstration recording associates instructions and observations with demonstrated robot states, actions, timestamps, and episode boundaries. During inference, current instructions and observations condition action intent or chunks, which pass through representation conversion and whole-body/hand controllers. The visit made synchronization a central design consideration: learning needs the relationship between what was requested, what was observed, and what the robot actually executed.

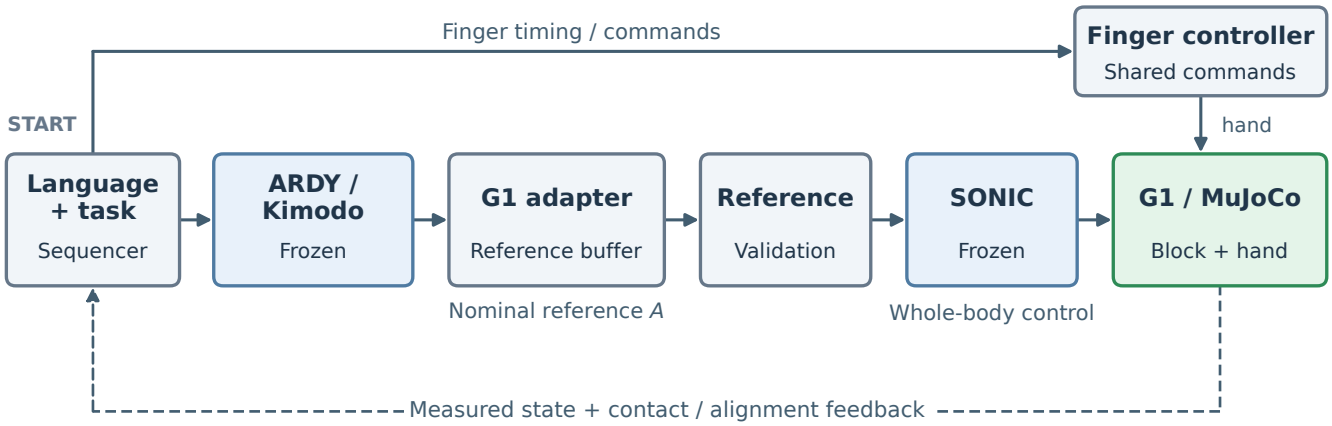


Fig. 1. Shared text-to-motion system, read from left to right. ARDY and Kimodo export a common G1 reference interface for frozen SONIC. Stage-specific finger commands follow a separate shared path; measured state and contact feedback support task coordination.

The resulting insight is that better generation and better execution address complementary problems. Our simulator exposes object pose and contacts directly; hardware requires sensing and state estimation, calibration, communication timing, and robust contact control. This motivated causal measured-history inputs, future nominal previews, synchronized rollout records, and explicit correction bounds, while keeping motion generation and SONIC frozen.

B. Related Work

Text-to-motion generation and whole-body control address different interfaces. ARDY's autoregressive diffusion supports interactive conditioning on recent motion, while Kimodo emphasizes controllable generation through spatial and kinematic constraints [1], [2]. Their outputs describe desired movement; adapting root orientation, joint order, sampling rate, and contact-sensitive hand goals determines how those outputs enter a robot controller. We compare these deployed systems under one SONIC executor, which supplies pretrained whole-body tracking [3].

Residual policy learning combines a base controller with a learned corrective action [5], [6]. Silver et al. and Johannink et al. study residuals through reinforcement learning; our controller uses supervised targets from verified recovery branches, causal teacher behavior, and stable identity examples. Temporal Transformers [7] encode recent execution together with future nominal motion. Auxiliary execution prediction gives the intermediate representation body and time structure, and the correction model consumes the predicted representation used at runtime.

This separates three design questions: which generator supplies useful nominal motion, whether learned feedback improves its execution, and when that feedback should run. Our generator benchmark, paired controller confirmation, and same-weight invocation ablation provide evidence for these respective questions.

III. Simulation System and Motion Baselines

A. Shared Task and Execution Interface

The MuJoCo [8] scene uses the Unitree G1 description [9] with a table and a dynamic, unattached block. The nominal setup uses a 6 cm cube and a 0.70 m table. A stage coordinator translates the task into reach, lower/alignment, finger closing, lift, and hold instructions. One recorded reach prompt is *"A person stands upright and slowly bends the right elbow, raising the open right hand upward beside the body, then extending the hand forward above the table. Both feet stay planted and the left arm stays at the side."* Phase prompts and simulator-grounded goals constrain the generated motion. This provides a reproducible staged language task with automated alignment replans.

Both generators export root translation, root quaternion, and 29 named body-joint angles, forming a 36-dimensional configuration. The adapters map joints by name, resample references to 50 Hz, and recompute velocities after interpolation and transitions. We use the released SONIC execution interface [10] for closed-loop whole-body tracking. Learned offsets change only the arms; root, torso, and leg references remain under SONIC, with planted-foot instructions and simulated ground contact supporting stance. Finger articulation is commanded separately using PD control and a 2.5 rad/s command-rate limit. The block remains governed by simulated contacts rather than an attachment to the hand.

The execution/state clock is 50 Hz and the physical task evaluator runs at 200 Hz. SONIC receives ten reference slots spaced by 0.1 s. Generation pauses simulated time, so command-response wall time and physical control time are measured separately. Generated references are checked against the compiled G1 joint ranges before installation.

B. ARDY and Kimodo Adapters

ARDY. The frozen ARDY-G1-RP-25FPS-Horizon8 model uses a shared 4,096-dimensional LLM2Vec text embedding [11], measured pose history, and end-effector/posture

constraints. Its native motion rate is 25 Hz and the deployed sampler uses ten denoising steps. Feedback-driven lower replans start from the robot's measured configuration. Native history conditioning makes ARDY a convenient base for the learning extension.

Kimodo. The frozen Kimodo-G1-RP-v1 model generates at 30 Hz with 100 denoising steps and text/constraint guidance weights of two. Its adapter converts phase goals into native wrist-position, wrist-rotation, and torso-rotation constraints. Measured history anchors the initial heading, state, and transition boundaries; it is not supplied as ARDY-style sequence conditioning. The maximum generated clip has 300 frames. The recorded baseline uses raw generated rotations with its calibrated wrist offset and no static forward-kinematic projection.

These are distinct motion generators sharing SONIC, the scene family, articulated hands, task criteria, and instruction coordinator. Method-specific grounding translates a common task goal into each generator's supported constraints. Both baselines run without additional human corrections; automatic alignment replans remain part of the implementation.

IV. Structured Predictive Risk and Residual Control

A. Measured History and Structured Prediction

At time t, the inputs are robot history S_t, nominal future A_t, and available phase/finger context C_t:

$$S_t \in \mathbb{R}^{16\times 119}, \quad A_t \in \mathbb{R}^{8\times 62}, \quad C_t \in \mathbb{R}^{8\times 23}. \tag{1}$$

Sixteen 50 Hz history samples span 0.30 s from first to last. Features include joint positions and velocities, root orientation, base angular velocity, relative palm/object geometry, contacts, tracking error, and phase. Future nominal tokens contain 29 positions, 29 velocities, and a root quaternion. The currently available phase and 14 finger commands are repeated across the future context; inference does not read future realized phases. Eight future slots spaced by 0.04 s extend to 0.28 s.

The Risk model predicts

$$(Z_t, p_t, \widehat{Y}_t) = \mathscr{G}_\phi(S_t, A_t, C_t), \qquad Z_t \in \mathbb{R}^{8\times 4\times 32}. \tag{2}$$

The four groups are left arm/hand, right arm/hand, torso, and lower body. Temporal and body indices preserve this structure while the token features are learned. Auxiliary heads predict tracking error, required-contact loss, balance instability, and intervention/onset labels. The full Z_t supplies correction with future-time and body-specific predictive context. The scalar p_t separately schedules invocation in selective mode.

Linear projections embed 16 history tokens and 32 body/time tokens into a pre-norm temporal Transformer [7]. The encoder has two layers, width 128, eight attention heads, a 512-dimensional feed-forward block, GELU, and final layer normalization. Attention pooling supplies the intervention head. Risk has 431,077 parameters.

B. Conditioned Correction and Smooth Execution

A second Transformer with the same backbone dimensions receives projected Risk tokens added to the nominal/context embeddings:

$$U_t = \mathscr{R}_\theta(S_t, A_t, C_t, Z_t), \qquad U_t \in \mathbb{R}^{8\times 14}. \tag{3}$$

The Residual model has 438,030 parameters and predicts the 14 arm-joint offsets. Other body-joint offsets are zero, while SONIC continues to control the whole body. The learned module retains the nominal reference and adjusts the arm configuration locally [6]. Auxiliary tracking, contact, and balance objectives shape Z_t, whose complete predicted token tensor conditions Residual.

Requested offsets are smoothly bounded and gated:

$$\Delta A_t^{\mathrm{req}} = 0.15 \tanh(U_t/0.15), \tag{4}$$

$$g_t = \mathbb{1}[p_t \geq 0.30], \qquad \Delta A_t^{\mathrm{cmd}} = g_t \Delta A_t^{\mathrm{req}}. \tag{5}$$

Always-on mode sets $g_t = 1$ while retaining Risk inference and the same Z_t conditioning. At approximately 10 Hz the controller predicts a horizon, executes the next step, and observes feedback again. The effective offset also passes through a shared magnitude/rate limiter:

$$\delta_t = \delta_{t-1} + \mathrm{clip}(\bar{\delta}_t - \delta_{t-1}, -0.5\Delta t, 0.5\Delta t), \quad |\delta_t| \leq 0.15, \tag{6}$$

where angles are in radians and $\bar{\delta}_t$ is the magnitude-limited request. The production implementation checks horizon and nominal-relative velocities as well. A low gate requests zero; an existing offset decays through the same rate limit. The last predicted slot is held over the remaining SONIC lookahead until replaced. This receding-horizon loop provides bounded local adaptation without retraining the generator or SONIC.

V. Data and Supervised Learning

A. Causal Supervision

We collect nominal executions and corrective teacher branches with their parent scene, measured state, reference inventory, and control settings. The Residual view has three supervision classes. *Verified recovery* pairs a failed nominal continuation with a successful corrected continuation at the exact intervention state. *Behavior cloning (BC)* uses later teacher states with their own measured histories. *Stable identity* requests zero correction on stable nominal execution. Exact intervention-state pairs teach recovery; subsequent teacher states teach how to sustain the corrected execution.

Targets are absolute requested arm offsets before the shared limiter, matching the runtime interface. The Risk view uses nominal execution with valid future labels. Normalization is fitted to Risk TRAIN nominal data and reused for validation and Residual training. Residual is conditioned on its frozen matching Risk model's predictions, matching deployment.

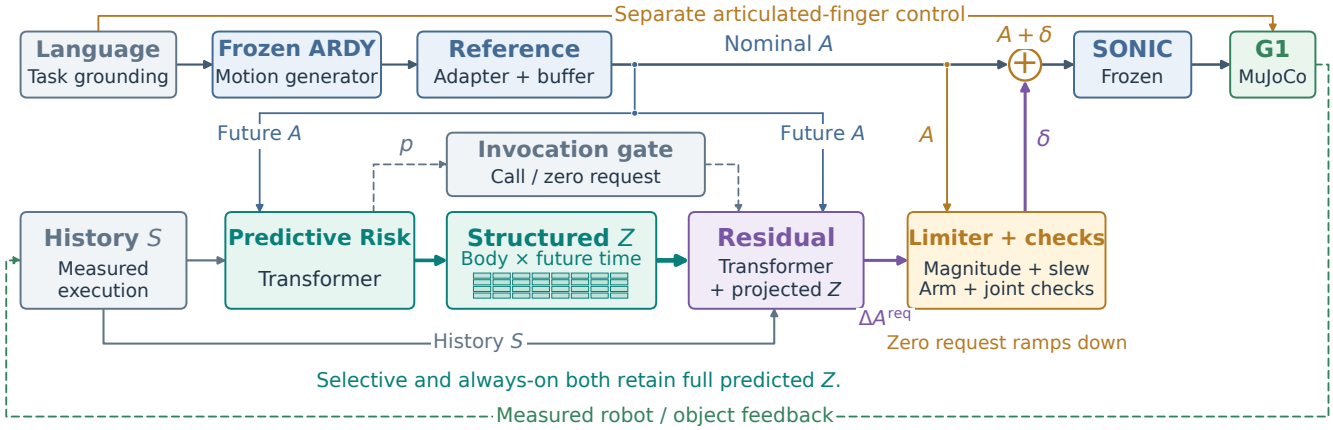


Fig. 2. Risk-conditioned execution loop. The frozen nominal route supplies A; measured history S and the future nominal preview feed both learned models. Risk transmits the full body-by-time representation Z to Residual (teal), while the dashed p branch schedules invocation. Requested arm offsets pass through shared limits and checks before addition to A and SONIC execution. Both schedules retain full predicted Z; finger control follows the separate upper path.

TABLE I
DATA AND TRAINING

	Risk	Residual
TRAIN parent executions	3,163	1,917
TRAIN windows	695,381	489,888
VAL windows	1,946	1,832
Executed / retained epoch	19 / 7	45 / 33
Optimizer updates	4,864	23,040
Best validation objective	0.188121	0.000344
Parameters	431,077	438,030

B. Losses and Optimization

Risk uses masked multi-task supervision,

$$\mathscr{L}_G = \mathscr{L}_{\text{int}} + 2(\mathscr{L}_{\text{track}} + \mathscr{L}_{\text{contact}} + \mathscr{L}_{\text{balance}}) + 0.25\mathscr{L}_{\text{onset}}. \tag{7}$$

Tracking uses MSE; contact, balance, intervention, and onset use valid-label BCE. Onset supervision distinguishes an upcoming event from a currently active violation. The Residual objective combines correction, BC, identity, and temporal smoothness:

$$\mathscr{L}_R = \mathscr{L}_{\text{corr}} + \mathscr{L}_{\text{BC}} + 2\mathscr{L}_{\text{id}} + 0.1\mathscr{L}_{\text{smooth}}. \tag{8}$$

Correction and BC emphasize the first executable step: 0.8 first-step error plus 0.2 weighted-horizon error. Each loss has its own availability mask and denominator. Sampling first chooses supervision kind and parent origin, then a branch and window; BC/identity/recovery masses are 0.2/0.4/0.4. Verified-correction windows comprise only 1,055 of 489,888 Residual windows, so uniform sampling would largely miss the intervention examples. The sampler allocates 40% of draws to recovery while retaining stable identity and sustained teacher behavior. Parent balancing also prevents long branches from dominating the update stream.

Training uses Moore Threads S4000 accelerators and MUSA/PyTorch. AdamW [12] uses learning rates $10^{-4}/2 \times 10^{-4}$ and batch sizes 128/64 for Risk/Residual. Each epoch draws 32,768 samples, with patience-12 validation early stopping. Table I reports actual training duration and retained checkpoints. Overlapping windows are training samples; parent executions identify source origins. Validation is fixed at eight nominal origins, of which seven supply admitted Residual parents. The appendix gives the supervision masks, sampling details, and recorded learning curves.

VI. Evaluation and Results

A. Evaluation Protocol

a) Task success and recorded metrics: A successful grasp requires opposing thumb/finger contact, block-bottom clearance of at least 0.05 m, and at least 2 s of continuous qualifying hold, followed by retention through the episode's final 5 s hold. Sticky post-lift loss, prohibited contact, or a fall makes the trial unsuccessful. The 200 Hz evaluator records contact and first-event evidence. Saved 50 Hz states support continuous-history and rendering checks. Human correction count excludes automatic coordinator replans.

All experiments, including simulation data collection, model training, and evaluation, run on the course-provided Moore Threads S4000 cluster. The generator study uses the recorded 100-trial batch for each method. It measures grasp success, command-to-first-reference wall time, joint tracking RMSE, and user corrections under the common task implementation. The learned-controller confirmation is a separate ARDY-based experiment. Its baseline disables learned arm correction; Ours adds Risk-conditioned Residual control with the same SONIC, fingers, coordinator, scene initialization, and task criteria.

b) Independent paired confirmation: The confirmation fixes 128 prospective origins. Each supplies an unscored nominal anchor and two scored arms, with order alternating by the original origin index. The reference policy is *symmetric hybrid*: covered requests use a shared frozen reference inventory; uncovered requests generate from each branch's own measured state under the same rule. Reach, lower, and

TABLE II
GENERATOR COMPARISON

	ARDY+SONIC	Kimodo+SONIC
Successful grasps	40/100	55/100
Initial threshold	58/100	58/100
Later sticky loss	18/58	3/58
Wilson 95% interval	30.94–49.80%	45.24–64.39%
Median initial response	4.36 s	7.44 s
Mean initial response	4.78 s	7.77 s
Mean joint RMSE	0.0924 rad	0.0955 rad
User corrections/trial	0	0

lift durations are 3.2, 3.2, and 4.8 s. Both weights and runtime settings are frozen before the cohort.

Complete end-to-end pairs are the primary units. A scored operational failure counts as unsuccessful. A common anchor rejection leaves both scored arms unattempted and missing; there are no replacement scenes. The paired analysis uses recorded task events, synchronized execution clocks, and matching scene initialization. For r rescues and h harms among n complete pairs, the estimated difference is $(r-h)/n$. The exact two-sided McNemar test [13] uses the prespecified family-wise allocation $\alpha = 0.00625$. A paired-origin percentile interval [14] uses 100,000 resamples with RNG seed 261010. The interval is a nominal 95% interval, separate from the multiplicity-controlled test.

B. ARDY versus Kimodo: 100 Trials per Method

We evaluate both frozen generators on the same 100 scene requests (seeds 60000–60099), with common stage instructions, block positions, SONIC settings, finger gains, and automatic alignment replans. Each adapter retains its calibrated wrist convention. All scheduled attempts are included, with zero additional user corrections.

Response is command-to-first-usable-reference wall time, including setup, and is separate from learned-controller timings.

Kimodo achieves 55% success versus ARDY's 40%, an observed 15 percentage-point advantage (Table II). There are 23 shared successes, 28 shared failures, 32 Kimodo-only successes, and 17 ARDY-only successes. ARDY produces the first reference faster and attains slightly lower joint-tracking RMSE, while Kimodo converts more executions into retained grasps.

a) Initial lifting versus sustained manipulation: The clearest distinction appears after the block first satisfies the task threshold. *Each generator reaches the clearance-and-contact threshold in 58/100 trials*, but ARDY retains 40 of these grasps through final assessment, compared with 55 for Kimodo. The sticky loss flag records 18 later losses for ARDY and three for Kimodo: 31.0% versus 5.2% of threshold-reaching trials. Sixteen ARDY losses receive the terminal reason `grasp_lost_after_success`; the other two terminate with prohibited contact. This distinguishes a convincing initial lift from sustained object control and explains why similar tracking accuracy can yield different task success.

b) Motion locality and grasp geometry: In the selected videos, ARDY sometimes couples the right-hand action with broader body motion, while Kimodo's grasp adjustments appear more localized. Whole-body coupling can change wrist–object geometry during closing and holding. Both methods use the same finger-controller settings and SONIC stabilization; their generated wrist geometry and subsequent motion differ. This makes contact-compatible reference motion a useful complement to joint-tracking accuracy.

Kimodo's dominant remaining bottleneck is alignment: 28 trials stop before acquisition, versus four acquisition failures, nine timeouts, and three post-threshold losses. ARDY has 17 acquisition failures and 18 timeouts in addition to its retention losses. The paired examples illustrate complementary strengths: Kimodo lifts while ARDY times out at seed 60000, but ARDY succeeds where Kimodo misses alignment at seed 60004. These results motivate adding execution-aware correction to the faster ARDY nominal chain, targeting contact and retention without replacing the generator.

Figure 4 illustrates the complementary outcome categories. The 17 ARDY-only successes show that Kimodo's overall advantage does not hold for every grasp geometry; local alignment remains sensitive to the generated wrist pose.

ARDY's measured-history conditioning and feedback replanning make it a useful platform for execution-side correction. Its acquisition and retention failures also leave room for a local controller to improve task completion without changing the motion generator.

C. Independent Evaluation of the Learned Extension

Of 128 scheduled origins, 124 have complete end-to-end pairs and four have common nominal-reference rejection. The 248 scored attempts yield 54 baseline successes (43.55%) and 74 successes for Ours (59.68%). The gain is $+16.13$ percentage points, or 37.04% relative to baseline. The paired table has 25 rescues, five harms, 49 shared successes, and 45 shared failures (Fig. 5). There are five rescues for each harm, producing a net gain of 20 successful origins.

The exact result is $p = 0.0003249142 < 0.00625$, satisfying the prospective decision rule. The nominal paired 95% interval is $[+8.06, +24.19]$ percentage points. One candidate operational failure is retained as unsuccessful end-to-end; both methods fail at that origin. Across all 128 scheduled origins, assigning every possible outcome to the four unresolved pairs gives empirical effect bounds of $[+12.50, +18.75]$ percentage points. The all-origin effect remains positive across these missing-outcome assignments. The appendix distinguishes these identification bounds from the complete-pair confidence interval.

D. Invocation Policies with Shared Risk Conditioning

The ablation compares ARDY baseline, selective correction at threshold 0.30, and always-on correction on a separate shared 20-origin cohort using one fixed ablation checkpoint pair. Successes are 3/20 (15%), 10/20 (50%), and 14/20 (70%), respectively. Relative to baseline, selective has seven

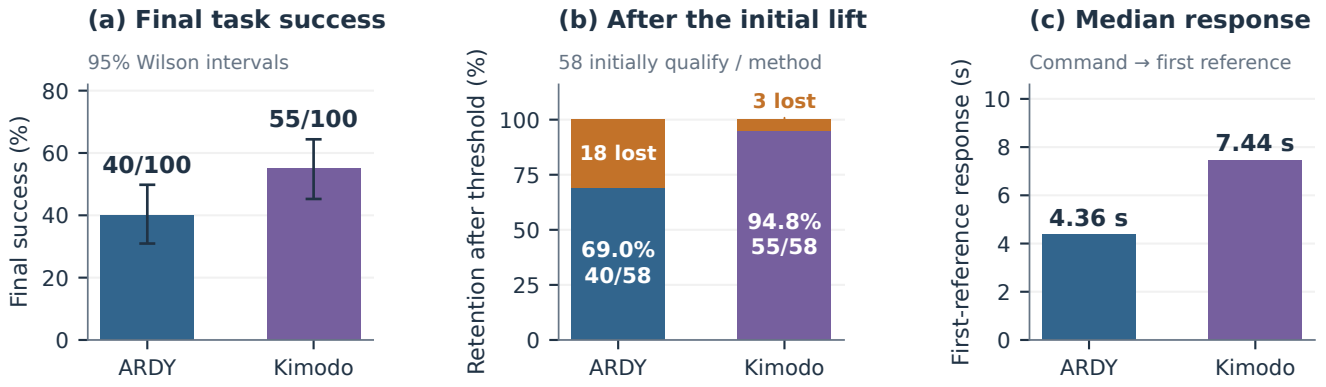


Fig. 3. Generator comparison on 100 shared scenes. Both methods initially meet the grasp threshold in 58 trials, but their subsequent retention differs. The middle panel conditions on each method's own 58 threshold-reaching trials; orange segments indicate later sticky losses. Final-success error bars are within-method 95% Wilson intervals. Response is command-to-first-reference time.

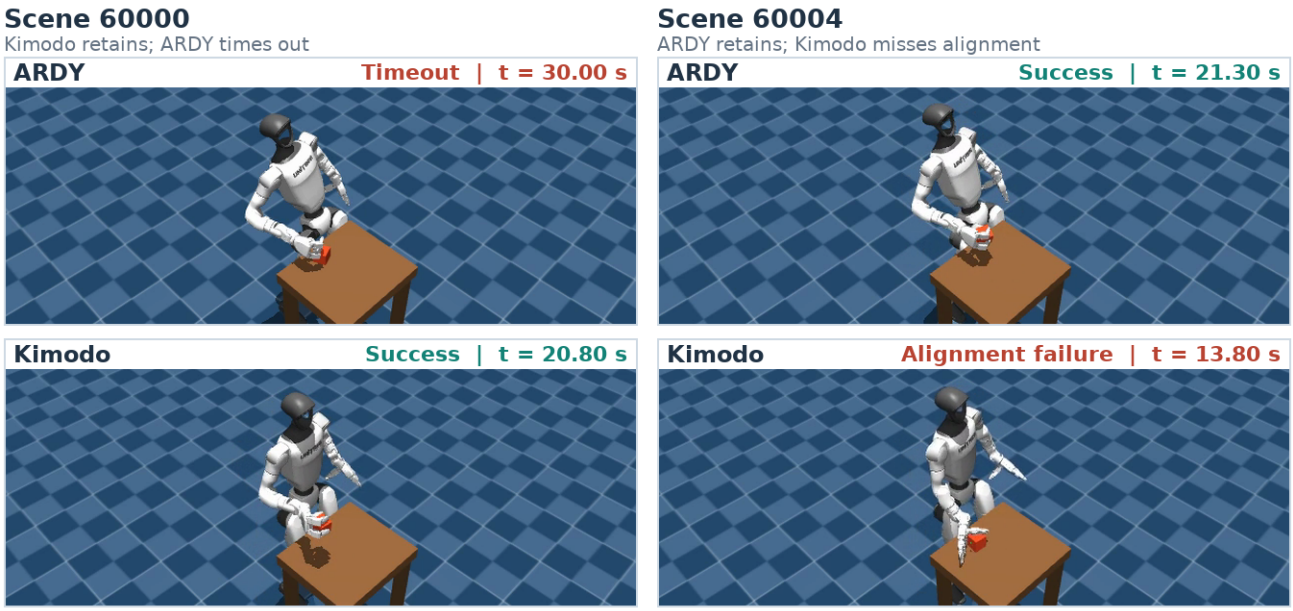


Fig. 4. Complementary outcomes in the 100-origin generator benchmark. In scene 60000, Kimodo succeeds while ARDY times out; in scene 60004, ARDY succeeds while Kimodo misses alignment. Frames show the final recorded physical state and simulation timestamp.

rescues and no harms, and always-on has 11 rescues and no harms. Comparing the learned modes directly gives five always-on rescues and one always-on harm.

Both learned modes compute Risk and pass the complete predicted token tensor to the same Residual model. Always-on applies Risk-conditioned correction at every learned update; selective execution adds a scalar invocation rule to that shared architecture. The observed difference concerns scheduling correction, with structured prediction supplying the corrective context in both modes. Two origins produce native lower-replan reference-guard failures in both learned arms; all four operational failures count as unsuccessful in the 20-origin end-to-end endpoint. This ablation is interpreted descriptively.

a) Computation–success trade-off: Selective execution invokes Residual on 1,575 of 4,172 Risk decisions (37.75%), skipping 62.25% of calls. Always-on invokes both models on all 4,075 decisions. Mean learned-controller time falls from 5.198 to 4.152 ms: a 20.13% reduction, or 1.046 ms per decision. Median/P95 times are 3.525/5.216 ms for selective and 5.127/6.062 ms for always-on. Timings include controller preparation and learned inference on each arm's own evolving trajectory, separate from generation, SONIC, physics, and rendering.

Risk and input preparation run in both modes, so skipping Residual saves only part of the learned-controller work. Both means fit within the 100 ms decision interval. On this hardware, always-on gives higher observed task success

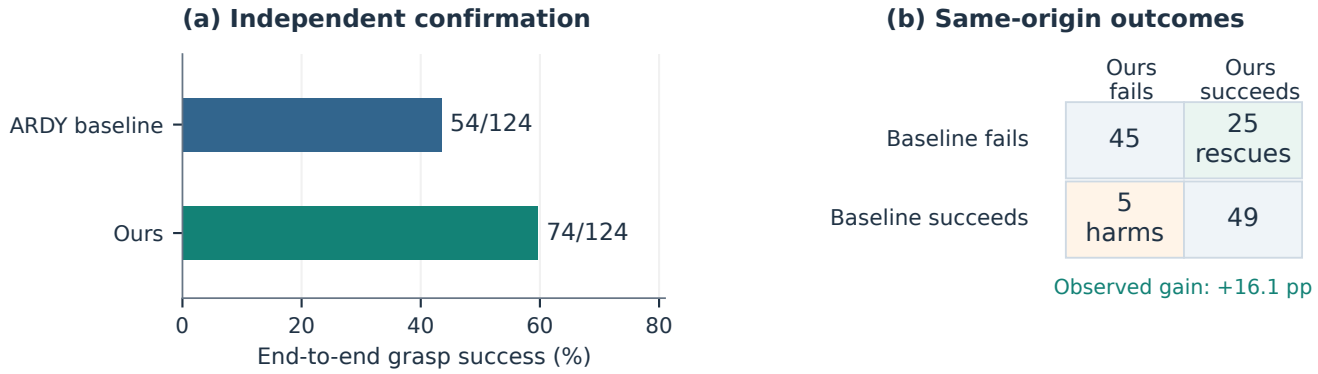


Fig. 5. Independent ARDY-based confirmation. Ours increases end-to-end success from 54 to 74 on 124 complete pairs. The paired outcomes reveal 25 rescues and five harms, with 49 shared successes and 45 shared failures. Four additional scheduled origins have common-anchor rejection and unattempted scored arms.

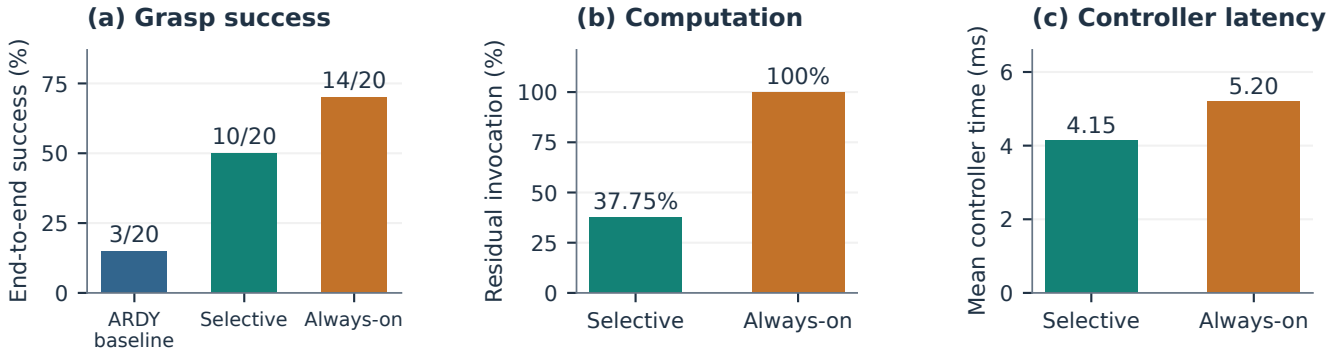


Fig. 6. Both learned configurations retain the same structured Risk-to-Residual pathway; the changed factor is Residual invocation. On 20 shared origins, always-on attains higher observed success, while selective invocation reduces Residual calls and controller latency. Learned weights are matched.

while selective invocation saves computation within the same decision budget. The shared structured interface supports either schedule.

E. Failures and Qualitative Evidence

a) Contact, clearance, and retention: Grasping has a sequence of geometric bottlenecks. The hand must first enter the closure region, establish opposing contact, and then maintain a compatible wrist orientation while lifting. A small tracking error can coexist with a poor contact configuration; conversely, a local reference offset can improve object interaction while slightly changing joint tracking. The failure categories distinguish these stages and explain why success requires full-episode retention.

Figures 7 and 10, together with the paired videos, make the correction effect concrete. At origin 76948, baseline reaches a 2.09 s qualifying hold but later loses the block; Ours retains it with a 7.395 s qualifying segment. At origin 77228, baseline succeeds with a 7.82 s hold, while the corrected branch drops after a 4.315 s segment. At shared-failure origin 76924, the corrected branch attains 0.071 m clearance but only 1.305 s of qualifying hold. These examples make sustained retention the decisive observable; peak block height alone misses both the recovery and the harmful correction.

b) Correction authority and remaining failures: Native joint-range rejection exposes a second interface bottleneck: a generated whole-body motion can be unacceptable before SONIC installs it. Arm-only correction has authority over contact geometry after reference acceptance, while the generator adapter must handle lower-body feasibility. The end-to-end endpoint includes both kinds of failure.

The five harms show that bounded correction can worsen an otherwise successful execution. Recovery, teacher behavior, and stable-identity supervision jointly train the Risk-conditioned model to repair failures, sustain contact, and preserve stable motion. These roles motivate evaluating successful continuation as well as immediate correction error.

VII. Discussion and Limitations

The generator comparison identifies contact retention as the main aggregate gap: equal initial threshold counts lead to different final outcomes. Our extension connects prediction to control through a structured intermediate representation. Future-time and body indices organize Risk features, and

TABLE III
TEAM CONTRIBUTIONS

Task	Team members
Archon session	All group members
Simulation and SONIC	Sun Yuhan, Tie Yutong, Gu Wentao, Wang Qifa
ARDY integration	Wang Yuxiang, Xia Fangxin, Yin Siyuan, Gu Wentao
Kimodo integration	Tie Yutong, Zang Ziyi, Zhu Jianyu, He Yutong
Execution data and labels	Lu Yinuo, Sun Yuhan, Wang Yuxiang, Gu Wentao
Risk/Residual models	Gu Wentao, Shi Yixin, Tie Yutong, Xia Fangxin
Training and optimization	Wang Qifa, Gu Wentao, Yin Siyuan, Zang Ziyi
Evaluation and ablations	Zhu Jianyu, He Yutong, Gu Wentao, Lu Yinuo
Video rendering and slides	Shi Yixin, Sun Yuhan, Yin Siyuan, Gu Wentao
Report and figures	Wang Qifa, Xia Fangxin, Gu Wentao, Zang Ziyi, Zhu Jianyu

Residual consumes their predicted values to adjust nominal execution. The independent confirmation establishes a task-level gain for this complete controller. The invocation study preserves that information pathway while comparing continuous and selective correction.

a) Scope and limitations: The experiments cover staged right-hand tabletop lifting of one block family, with simulator-grounded object state. Transfer to new shapes, payloads, bimanual tasks, or estimated visual state remains to be measured. Generation pauses simulated time, so millisecond learned-controller latency establishes a component budget; real-robot deployment also requires asynchronous planning and measured sensing/control delays. The eight-origin validation split has limited diversity despite the larger training set, motivating broader origin-level validation.

The independent confirmation measures the complete Risk-conditioned controller. The invocation ablation preserves full Z_t in both modes; it therefore isolates call scheduling. Matched binary-, scalar-, body-vector-, and full-token conditioning studies are still needed to quantify the contribution of risk structure itself. Learned corrections affect only the arms, and five confirmation harms show that magnitude/rate bounds alone do not guarantee useful contact changes. The next evaluation should test these interfaces and contact-preservation behavior across tasks.

The public implementation repository provides configurations, setup instructions, and evaluation code. The report supplement provides editable source, recorded learning curves, numerical summaries with source hashes, and annotated success/failure videos for both generators and the learned extension. We acknowledge ARDY, Kimodo, GEAR-SONIC/GR00T-WholeBodyControl, Unitree G1 assets, Llama [15]/LLM2Vec, and MuJoCo. LLM assistance supported implementation and drafting; external materials retain their original licenses.

VIII. CONCLUSION AND FUTURE OUTLOOK

Two motion generators share one SONIC execution pipeline, yet differ in response time, alignment, and retention. Our learned extension transmits structured predictions of future execution from Risk to Residual, linking anticipation to bounded arm correction. This Risk-conditioned controller improves the ARDY-based system from 43.55% to 59.68% success in an independent paired evaluation. Both continuous and selective invocation retain the predictive interface. Table III gives the team task allocation.

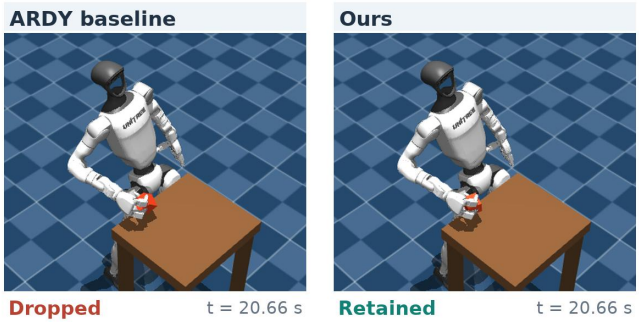


Fig. 7. Contact retention at origin 76948. Baseline loses the block after a 2.09 s qualifying segment; Ours retains it through final assessment. Both images show the original terminal state at 20.66 s.

Future work will evaluate this controller on a physical G1 under supervision, using visual state estimation, calibrated timing, and measured contact feedback. Object placement, bimanual handling, and transport will test whether the learned interface transfers beyond tabletop lifting. Integrating a vision-language-action (VLA) policy, such as OpenVLA [16], upstream will extend visual and instruction conditioning while retaining the structured Risk-to-Residual interface. Dynamics randomization [17] offers a route to stress-test friction, payload, and actuator mismatch before hardware trials. More diverse objects, task conditions, and validation origins will support this progression.

REFERENCES

[1] K. Zhao, M. Petrovich, H. Zhang, T. Wang, S. Tang, and D. Rempe, "ARDY: Autoregressive diffusion with hybrid representation for interactive human motion generation," *ACM Transactions on Graphics*, vol. 45, no. 4, 2026, article 86. [Online]. Available: https://research.nvidia.com/labs/sil/projects/ardy/

[2] D. Rempe, M. Petrovich, Y. Yuan, H. Zhang, X. B. Peng, Y. Jiang, T. Wang, U. Iqbal, D. Minor, M. de Ruyter, J. Li, C. Tessler, E. Lim, E. Jeong, S. Wu, E. Hassani, M. Huang, J.-B. Yu, C. Chung, L. Song, O. Dionne, J. Kautz, S. Yuen, and S. Fidler, "Kimodo: Scaling controllable human motion generation," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2603.15546*, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2603.15546

[3] Z. Luo, Y. Yuan, T. Wang, C. Li, F. Castañeda, S. Chen, Z.-A. Cao, J. Li, D. Minor, Q. Ben, J. Park, D. Sami, Z. Wang, X. Da, R. Ding, C. Hogg, L. Song, E. Lim, E. Jeong, T. He, H. Xue, W. Xiao, S. Yuen, J. Kautz, Y. Chang, U. Iqbal, L. Fan, and Y. Zhu, "SONIC: Supersizing motion tracking for natural humanoid whole-body control," *Science Robotics*, vol. 11, no. 117, p. eaed4592, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://www.science.org/doi/abs/10.1126/scirobotics.aed4592

[4] Archon Robotics, "Whole-body intelligence: The pretraining path to large humanoid models," Official technical article, July 13, 2026, accessed October 16, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://www.archon.tech/blog/whole-body-intelligence

[5] T. Silver, K. Allen, J. Tenenbaum, and L. Kaelbling, "Residual policy learning," *arXiv preprint arXiv:1812.06298*, 2018. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/1812.06298

[6] T. Johannink, S. Bahl, A. Nair, J. Luo, A. Kumar, M. Loskyll, J. A. Ojea, E. Solowjow, and S. Levine, "Residual reinforcement learning for robot control," in *IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation*, 2019, pp. 6023–6029.

[7] A. Vaswani, N. Shazeer, N. Parmar, J. Uszkoreit, L. Jones, A. N. Gomez, Ł. Kaiser, and I. Polosukhin, "Attention is all you need," in *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems*, vol. 30, 2017.

[8] E. Todorov, T. Erez, and Y. Tassa, "MuJoCo: A physics engine for model-based control," in *IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems*, 2012, pp. 5026–5033.

[9] Unitree Robotics, "Unitree G1 description (URDF and MJCF)," Official robot-description repository, accessed October 16, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://github.com/unitreerobotics/unitree_ros/tree/master/robots/g1_description

[10] NVIDIA, "GR00T-WholeBodyControl: GEAR-SONIC software and documentation," Official software repository, accessed October 16, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://github.com/NVlabs/GR00T-WholeBodyControl

[11] P. BehnamGhader, V. Adlakha, M. Mosbach, D. Bahdanau, N. Chapados, and S. Reddy, "LLM2Vec: Large language models are secretly powerful text encoders," in *First Conference on Language Modeling*, 2024. [Online]. Available: https://openreview.net/forum?id=IW1PR7vEBf

[12] I. Loshchilov and F. Hutter, "Decoupled weight decay regularization," in *International Conference on Learning Representations*, 2019. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/1711.05101

[13] Q. McNemar, "Note on the sampling error of the difference between correlated proportions or percentages," *Psychometrika*, vol. 12, no. 2, pp. 153–157, 1947.

[14] B. Efron, "Bootstrap methods: Another look at the jackknife," *The Annals of Statistics*, vol. 7, no. 1, pp. 1–26, 1979.

[15] Meta, "Meta Llama 3 model card," Official model card, 2024, released April 18, 2024; accessed October 16, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://github.com/meta-llama/llama3/blob/main/MODEL_CARD.md

[16] M. J. Kim, K. Pertsch, S. Karamcheti, T. Xiao, A. Balakrishna, S. Nair, R. Rafailov, E. P. Foster, P. R. Sanketi, Q. Vuong, T. Kollar, B. Burchfiel, R. Tedrake, D. Sadigh, S. Levine, P. Liang, and C. Finn, "OpenVLA: An open-source vision-language-action model," in *Proceedings of the 8th Conference on Robot Learning*, ser. Proceedings of Machine Learning Research, vol. 270. PMLR, 2025, pp. 2679–2713. [Online]. Available: https://proceedings.mlr.press/v270/kim25c.html

[17] X. B. Peng, M. Andrychowicz, W. Zaremba, and P. Abbeel, "Sim-to-real transfer of robotic control with dynamics randomization," in *IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation*, 2018, pp. 3803–3810. [Online]. Available: https://xbpeng.github.io/projects/SimToReal/